

DDoS Incident Analysis

Submitted by Sneha K

Five recent DDoS incidents

Cloudflare — 7.3 Tbps attack (May 2025)

Cloudflare reported mitigating a 7.3 terabits/sec UDP volumetric attack (the then-largest recorded), delivered to a single IP and lasted ~45 seconds. This attack used high packet-per-second rates and reflection/amplification vectors

Cloudflare — 22.2 Tbps hyper-volumetric attack (Oct 2025)

Cloudflare disclosed mitigation of a later record-scale DDoS that peaked at ~22.2 Tbps and ~10.6 billion pps; it was short (tens of seconds) but extremely intense and under investigation for source and vector details.

Aisuru botnet — mass attacks on gaming platforms (Oct 6, 2025)

Multiple outlets reported a huge coordinated outage affecting Steam, Riot Games, PlayStation Network and others on Oct 6, 2025; reporting and DDoS telemetry pointed to the Aisuru botnet and an alleged peak in the tens of Tbps (figures vary among sources).

KrebsOnSecurity — sustained multi-Tbps hits (May 2025 / Aisuru)

Veteran reporting showed that the Aisuru botnet delivered multi-terabit attacks against security journalists and other targets earlier in 2025, including an attack exceeding 6 Tbps and later >11 Tbps against monitored targets.

Gaming / Blizzard outages and player impact (Mar 2025 & early 2025 incidents)

Blizzard acknowledged and documented DDoS incidents that disrupted Diablo IV and World of Warcraft Hardcore realms in early 2025, with severe gameplay impact (lost characters, disconnects) and public remediation steps

such as character restoration. These incidents illustrate the downstream, user-facing harm of targeted gaming DDoS campaigns

Selected incident: *Oct 6, 2025 gaming-platform outages suspected to be caused by the Aisuru botnet (multi-Tbps attack on Steam, Riot, PlayStation, others).* Sources: reporting from FastNetMon, PC Gamer, Cybernews and corroborating telemetry.

1) Target

- **Primary targets reported:** major gaming platforms and services — *Steam, Riot Games (League/Valorant), PlayStation Network, and others* — causing widespread player disconnections and service degradation. The attack appears to have targeted the game providers’ public-facing infrastructure (game servers, matchmaking, frontend services) and also affected CDN/hosting nodes in some regions.

2) Technology used (attack vectors & methods)

- **Botnet-driven volumetric flood:** reporting identifies *Aisuru*—a large botnet composed of compromised endpoints (likely IoT/routers/embedded devices)—as a suspected source, capable of generating extremely high packet and bandwidth volumes. The attack produced massive packet-per-second (pps) and terabit/sec traffic, consistent with UDP floods and “carpet-bombing” TCP/UDP traffic patterns.
- **Reflection/amplification & spoofing elements:** previous record DDoS incidents in 2025 used reflection/amplification (UDP-based) techniques; while not every report names the exact vector for Oct 6, the volumes and pps suggest similar methods or vast raw botnet capacity.
- **Short, extremely high-rate bursts:** modern mega-DDoS campaigns are characterized by very short duration (seconds to a few minutes) but enormous peaks, optimized to saturate links and overwhelm stateful frontends. Reports for Oct 6 describe a short but intense surge.

3) Attacker's motive (inferred)

- **Likely motives include:** disruption (griefing/competitive sabotage in gaming), proving botnet capability / notoriety (showing scale), and testing extortion/pressure tactics against large commercial targets. Public reporting around Aisuru suggests some attacks are designed to test strength or to cause high-visibility outages rather than immediate financial theft. There's no public, confirmed ransom demand tied to Oct 6 at time of reporting.

4) Overall impact

- **Service outages and user disruption:** millions of players experienced disconnects, login failures, and degraded game experiences; some platforms posted status pages about service interruptions. DOWNDetector/ social channels showed large outage volumes.
- **Operational stress for providers & mitigators:** the sheer volume (tens of Tbps claimed by some telemetry outlets) forced large-scale mitigation action by CDNs, DDoS scrubbing providers and ISPs; such attacks also increase operational cost and risk of collateral impact to other services sharing infrastructure.
- **Reputational and player-community damage:** gaming communities reported lost progress and disrupted competitive events; for multiplayer-centric businesses this erodes trust and can have long-term engagement effects.

5) Defensive strategies that could have mitigated

Below are practical, defense-in-depth controls that networking and security teams should combine to mitigate (and absorb) attacks of this scale. I pair each recommendation with reasoning and, where possible, supporting practice from mitigation providers.

A. Upstream capacity & Anycast + load distribution

- **What:** Use a globally distributed Anycast network fronted by multiple scrubbing sites / CDNs to spread volumetric load across many locations so no single link is saturated.
- **Why:** Anycast and distribution convert an attack against a single IP into multiple weaker flows across many POPs, reducing local congestion and increasing scrubbing options. Cloudflare and other CDNs rely on this approach for terabit-scale defense.

B. Dedicated scrubbing & ISP coordination

- **What:** Contract with DDoS scrubbing providers and maintain relationships with transit ISPs for rapid traffic redirection (BGP announcements) to scrubbing centers.
- **Why:** For hyper-volumetric attacks, local edge devices can't absorb traffic; scrubbing centers remove malicious traffic upstream. Fast response and pre-established playbooks minimize outage time.

C. High packet-per-second (pps) protection & stateful limits

- **What:** Deploy or source protection that handles extreme pps (not just Gbps). Use hardware capable of line-rate filtering and set rate limits for UDP/ICMP and SYN floods, and use stateless filtering to drop obviously spoofed/reflected traffic.
- **Why:** Attacks with huge pps (billions of packets/sec) overwhelm stateful devices; filtering at the edge or upstream prevents state exhaustion. Cloudflare's and Nokia's telemetry emphasize pps as a growing vector.

D. Application-layer protections & WAF for mixed attacks

- **What:** Combine volumetric mitigation with application-layer WAF, challenge pages (CAPTCHA/JS puzzles), and rate-limiting for login/matchmaking endpoints.
- **Why:** If attackers mix volumetric and application attacks (or aim to exploit game protocols), application defenses reduce the effectiveness of non-volumetric vectors.

E. Harden IoT/edge ecosystem & supply-side controls

- **What:** Long-term: coordinate with ISPs and device manufacturers to remediate vulnerable IoT that fuels botnets (e.g., patchable firmware, no default creds, ISP filtering). Use RPKI, egress filtering (BCP38) to limit spoofing.
- **Why:** Many terabit attacks are enabled by weak IoT devices and source-spoofing; stopping that growth requires industry cooperation. Nokia's threat reports call out compromised home devices as a major source

F. Rapid telemetry & automated playbooks

- **What:** Maintain monitoring for pps/Gbps anomalies, automated BGP failover/playbooks, and run tabletop exercises with ISPs/CDNs to verify the plan.

- **Why:** Hyper-bursts require millisecond-to-minute reaction; automated mitigations reduce time to protection and human error. Cloudflare and others recommend automation and rehearsed escalation.

G. Legal/abuse engagement & threat intel

- **What:** Share telemetry with CERTs, ISPs, and DDoS research groups; feed indicators to law enforcement where extortion or criminal behavior is suspected.
 - **Why:** Coordinated takedown of botnet C2 infrastructure and ISP-level filtering can reduce future attacks; public reporting also helps the ecosystem adapt.
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Quick remediation checklist

1. Ensure CDN + Anycast coverage for public endpoints.
 2. Maintain DDoS scrubbing contracts and tested BGP failover.
 3. Tune edge devices for high-pps filtering and set conservative thresholds for UDP/SYN floods.
 4. Put critical API endpoints behind WAF and rate limits, require proof-of-work/challenge for heavy endpoints.
 5. Participate in ISP/industry info sharing and pursue IoT remediation programs.
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Sources

- Cloudflare — “How Cloudflare blocked a monumental 7.3 Tbps DDoS” and Q2 2025 DDoS threat report. [The Cloudflare Blog+1](#)
- KrebsOnSecurity — reporting on Aisuru botnet DDoS history (May 2025 and follow-ups). [Krebs on Security](#)
- FastNetMon / DDoS news coverage — Oct 6, 2025 suspected gaming-platform attack (Aisuru suspected; peak Tbps reported by telemetry). [FastNetMon](#)
- PC Gamer / Cybernews / Tom’s Hardware — contemporary reporting on gaming outages and Cloudflare mitigations. [PC Gamer+2Cybernews+2](#)

- Nokia / industrial cyber reporting — industry threat intelligence noting rise in short, intense DDoS attacks and IoT as major contributor.